

POCO X5 Pro 5G

For avid mobile gamers

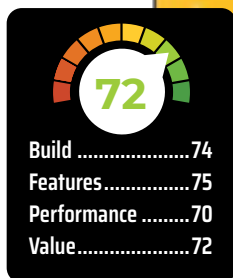
In the sub-₹25,000 segment of smartphones we have yet another performance-focussed competitor in this crowded category from the house of POCO dubbed the POCO X5 Pro. The POCO X5 Pro seems like an enticing offering in this price segment but does the tested data confirm the same? Let's find out.

BUILD AND DISPLAY

The POCO X5 Pro 5G is available in three colourways – Black, Blue, and Yellow. The Yellow and Black colour scheme looks fantastic and classy. The design has been overhauled from the X4 Pro, with the X5 Pro featuring a matte-textured back glass panel which is extremely resistant to fingerprints. The camera module design has also been changed too. On the right, you have an accented yellow power button that also doubles as a capacitive fingerprint sensor. The fingerprint sensor doesn't work consistently though. The buttons – both the power and volume buttons – are clicky and tactile enough. The phone also has a dual-SIM tray at the bottom and a Type-C charging port. On the top, you have a 3.5 mm audio jack, which is always a pleasant sight. As for the display, it comes with Dolby Vision and HDR10+ support making it fantastic for content consumption. Colours look rich and vibrant, with deep blacks. In sunlight, we recorded a peak brightness of 802 nits which is bright enough for easy reading outdoors.

PERFORMANCE

The POCO X5 Pro is powered by the speedy Qualcomm Snapdragon 778G 5G SoC. We kicked off our performance tests with the AnTuTu benchmark where the phone managed to bag impressive scores. It only lagged significantly behind the similarly



priced Redmi K50i. The same trend could be seen in Geek-Bench and PCMarkWork as well. We tried running 3D Mark and GFXBench, however, these apps were being blocked from accessing the internet. It is possible that the apps may get whitelisted in a few days via a firmware update. We also ran the CPU Throttling Test and were impressed to see that the phone retained 94 per cent of its peak performance while still remaining fairly cool to the touch. The gaming performance impressed us. You can easily play games on this phone with minimal to no lag or stutters. Multitasking is also fantastic and the 120 Hz display makes the phone's performance feel even more smooth. The UI, however, is rife with bloatware, many of which can be uninstalled. Bloatware aside, there are a lot of customisation options, which are always welcome.

CAMERAS

Our, initial impressions tell us that the phone's cameras are mediocre and we think they should have been tuned better. Photos in daylight, with ideal lighting conditions, are decent enough. However, if there's harsh lighting in the background, there's a lot of lens flare. Portrait shots

come out fine, but the edge detection isn't the best. The ultrawide lens suffers from worse dynamic range, especially in tricky lighting. Low-light shots from the primary and ultrawide lenses are some level of noise and grain even with Night Mode active. The 2 MP macro lens is just there to boost numbers. 4K video is available at 30 fps but while the colours look decent in daylight, detail retention isn't the best. There's also a 16 MP selfie camera that also suffers from lens flare and you often get soft photos that lack detail. The problem of noise creeps in during low light selfie shots as well.

BATTERY LIFE

The battery life impressed us quite a bit. The phone easily lasts an entire day even with heavy gaming and if you're a relatively light mobile user, you can even squeak out two days' worth of runtime. In our 4K video loop test, the phone lasted a little over 18 hours, which is truly fantastic. The phone also comes packing a speedy 67 W fast charger in the box that charges the phone from empty to full in merely 52 minutes.

VERDICT

The POCO X5 Pro 5G is a mobile gamer's dream. It performs incredibly well with smooth gameplay and minimal heat at Very High settings. It also runs just about any task you throw at it and will only show signs of stutter and lag in something like a Genshin Impact. For its aggressive price tag, it is a fantastic performance-oriented phone that we wouldn't shy away from recommending. However, something like the Redmi K50i would get a stronger recommendation from us since these phones are similarly priced and it generally performs slightly better.

–Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: Qualcomm Snapdragon 778G 5G | GPU: Adreno 642L | RAM: 6/8 GB LPDDR4X | ROM: 128/256 GB UFS 2.2 | OS: Android 12, MIUI 14 | Display: 6.67-inches AMOLED | Resolution: Full HD+ | Display refresh rate: 120 Hz | Cameras (rear): 108 MP + 8 MP + 2 MP | Camera (front): 16 MP | Battery: 5,000 mAh with 67 W charging

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